Search Engine Optimization

What is a Search Engine & SEO?

A **Search Engine** is a program that searches for and identifies items in a database, corresponding to keywords or characters entered by a user, to locate specific websites on the World Wide Web.

Search engines serve two primary purposes:

- To assist in organizing information so that people can locate it
- To provide individuals with relevant and reliable information when needed

Search Engine Optimization (SEO) is a collection of strategies aimed at improving the visibility and positioning of web pages in non-ad/non-paid search results. The main goal of SEO is to improve the likelihood of your business appearing in the search results by maximizing the opportunity to gain traffic from search engines.

Pillars of SEO Strategy

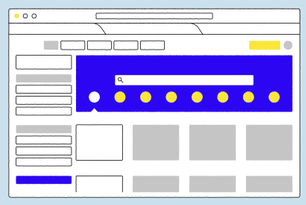
Keywords: Conduct a keyword analysis to find the best keywords for your industry, products, and services



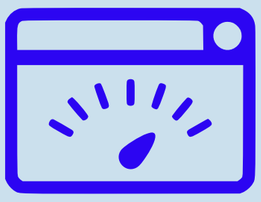
Content: Optimize your content to improve readability and to make it easy to skim through for a better user experience



Architecture: Having a well structured website ensures a positive experience for your visitors



Page Speed: The quicker your page loads, the higher it will be ranked by a search engine



Metadata: Webpage source code that describes what the website is about

Backlinking: The number of times other webpages direct traffic to your website

Social Media: A great tool to share your content and generate backlinks for your website

Components of Good SEO Strategy

Audience Analysis

Cater your content and SEO strategy to your target audience, as these are the people you want interacting with your business the most.

To understand your current and potential customer base, you can do the following:

- Interview current customers
- Review your FAQs
- Make educated assumptions based on experiences
- Talk to other prospects and customers

Headlines

Want to use compelling headlines to draw attention to your website.

Headline best practices:

- Incorporate your keywords
- Answer "what's in it for me"
- Use language that helps the reader understand
- Try to include a quantifiable date point

Keywords

Ideas and topics that are used to describe what your content is about. Keywords are what people type into a search engine to find what they are looking for. Ensure your keywords are generated from a customer's perspective.

There are 4 main types of keyword search intent:

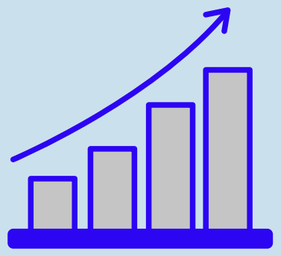
- *Informational:* searches looking for a piece of information
- *Navigational:* searches looking for a specific website
- *Transactional:* searches looking for something to buy
- *Commercial:* searches looking for information to support a purchase

Structuring Content

Optimizing your content to make it easy to read and digest is important to ensure that a reader can get the information they need even while skimming the page.

Web Analytics & Tracking

Web Analytics allow you to track information and metrics on your website. Web analytics can be very useful for seeing which areas you are doing well, and where you can improve on your website. There are hundreds of metrics that you can access but some of the most important include:



- **Users** – How many unique people have visited your site
- **Sessions** – The number of times your site was visited
- **Average Session Duration** – How long your average session was
- **Bounce Rate** – The percentage of users who took no action on a website
- **Goal Conversion** – The percentage of users who complete a specific goal that is pre-defined by the business (ie. sign up for the newsletter, book an appointment, complete a purchase, etc.)
- **Sales Conversion** – a sale on your e-commerce website

Start Your SEO Strategy Today

It's important to include a strategy of how you plan to implement SEO into your business model. A strategy consists of the actions that take you from Point A (your current state) to Point B (your desired future state).

In your SEO Strategy, be sure to consider:

- A focus on social media, content marketing and public relations
- Understanding competitors and possibilities
- Using articles, blogs and leading pages to buy your products/services
- Posting content regularly on social media platforms to keep your company front of mind

You can find a list of free SEO tools to help get you stared in this Blog.